

76.2 APPROXIMATE STATISTICS

Statistics can be made more general by modifying them with words such as “approximately,” “about,” “just,” “well,” or “almost.”



Approximately
About } half of the students are from Europe.

Indicate that the quantity is not exact.



Just under a third of the assessment consists of coursework.

Indicates that the difference is small.



Well over 50 percent of the course is online.

Indicates that the difference is large.



Almost all of the lessons are one hour long.

Indicates that the number is slightly less.

76.3 SURPRISING NUMBERS

Certain expressions are used to show that a particular number or quantity is surprising.



Other universities charge **as much as** €100 for this service.

This indicates that €100 is a surprisingly large amount of money.



For **as little as** \$5 per semester, you can join the club.

This indicates that \$5 is a surprisingly small amount of money.



There are **as many as** 25 free student events each month.

This indicates that 25 is a surprisingly large number of events.



The library is generally closed for **as few as** 2 days a month.

This indicates that 2 is a surprisingly small number of days.